

MUJTABA SHAHID

Cybersecurity · Penetration Testing · Secure Software Development

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SUMMARY

Data and Cybersecurity graduate from the University of Doha for Science and Technology. Hands-on experience in penetration testing, IoT and OT security, secure software development, and security monitoring and incident response, built through university labs, a capstone on zero-trust architecture for multi-agent AI systems, and self-directed certification work. Comfortable leading small teams — consistently served as group lead across university projects, with an A in Project Management. Currently completing CEH v13. QID is valid and transferable with NOC.

EXPERIENCE

Web Developer & Designer (Intern) | *NOVERA.DEV, Doha, Qatar* May 2025 – Jan 2026

- Built and launched two Shopify storefronts end-to-end, handling theme customisation, store setup, and mobile responsiveness.
- Shipped responsive frontend work on internal portfolio sites (LIKO, Rivor), focusing on page performance and clean layouts.
- Moved client builds onto WordPress with Elementor and WooCommerce as the agency shifted its stack.
- Picked up the basics of Git workflows, CI/CD, and deployment as part of the agency's DevOps rollout.

Event Operations Coordinator (Freelance) | *The Planners W.L.L. — FIFA World Cup 2022* Nov – Dec 2022

- Ran on-site logistics across stadium zones — crowd flow, guest navigation, and entry/exit operations during matchdays.
- Coordinated VIP protocols, media access, and transport routing under live matchday pressure.
- Held the comms line between event control, hospitality, and venue security to keep issues moving in real time.

Customer Service Agent, Airport Services | *Qatar Airways* Oct 2021 – Jan 2022

- Handled flight bookings, reschedules, and special-assistance requests on the Amadeus ticketing system.
- Worked boarding gate operations alongside ground ops teams to keep departures on schedule.
- Supported distressed passengers during peak travel hours while staying within IATA and airline service protocols.
- Achieved outstanding customer feedback through effective problem - solving and attentive service.

PROJECTS

Decentralized Zero Trust Proxy for MCP *Capstone Project, UDST*

- Built a zero-trust proxy layer that secures inter-agent communication in multi-agent AI systems using the Model Context Protocol (MCP).
- Addressed prompt injection, agent authentication, and trust verification — drew on research into MCP-Guard, zkMCP, and SAMOS.
- Five-person team under a PhD supervisor; led architecture decisions and wrote the zero-trust chapter of the capstone report.

Stack: Python · FastAPI · Docker · JWT · MCP

Hospital Management System *Secure Software Development Project, UDST*

- Desktop application for patient and staff management with role-based access control and secure data handling.
- Built on OOP design principles, with separation between domain logic, persistence, and UI layers.

Stack: Java · JavaFX · SQLite · IntelliJ IDEA

COURSEWORK HIGHLIGHTS

Penetration Testing

- Full-cycle pentesting labs on isolated networks — reconnaissance, exploitation, privilege escalation, lateral movement, and network pivoting.
- Hands-on with Metasploit, MSFvenom, Meterpreter, Burp Suite, Nmap, Wireshark, Nessus, OpenVAS, and Aircrack-ng.
- Studied Active Directory attack paths (Pass-the-Hash, Kerberoasting, DCSync) and wireless attacks (WEP/WPA cracking, Evil Twin, Deauth).

IoT and OT Security

- Attacked and hardened a Flask-based IoT web app on an isolated Raspberry Pi — token leakage, CSRF, plaintext traffic, and unauthorised device control.
- Simulated HTTP flood DoS against the same setup and analysed the traffic in Wireshark.
- Firmware analysis with Binwalk; exposure to MQTT, BLE, Zigbee, Z-Wave, and SCADA/ICS concepts.

Secure Software Development

- Threat modelling with STRIDE, PASTA, and DREAD; applied secure SDLC and DevSecOps principles across lab projects.
- Worked with cryptographic building blocks (AES, RSA, SHA, HMAC, JWT, TLS) and secure API patterns (OAuth 2.0, REST).
- Covered SAST/DAST, input validation, output encoding, and dependency risk management.

Incident Response and Security Monitoring

- SIEM log analysis and threat hunting exercises in Splunk, including Windows artefact investigation (file paths, SHA-256 hashes, command-line strings).
- SOC maturity models (CMMI, COBIT), incident response lifecycles (NIST, SANS), and MITRE ATT&CK mapping.
- Exposure to CTI frameworks — MISP, STIX/TAXII, YARA, and Sigma rules.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages Python, Java, Bash, SQL, PowerShell, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, YAML

Security Tools (hands-on) Metasploit, MSFvenom, Burp Suite, Nmap, Wireshark, Tcpdump, Nessus, OpenVAS, Aircrack-ng, Splunk

Security Tools (studied) BloodHound, Mimikatz, Impacket, CrackMapExec, Hydra, Hashcat, John the Ripper, SQLmap, Scapy, Snort, Suricata, Empire

IoT / OT Raspberry Pi, Binwalk, MQTT; exposure to Arduino, ESP32, HackRF, RTL-SDR, QEMU, Zigbee, Z-Wave

Dev & Lab Git, GitHub, Docker, VS Code, IntelliJ IDEA, Eclipse, VMware, VirtualBox, Jupyter, Packet Tracer

Cloud (studied) AWS (EC2, S3, IAM, Lambda, VPC, CloudTrail, CloudWatch), Azure, GCP

Frameworks MITRE ATT&CK, NIST CSF, OWASP Top 10, SANS, Cyber Kill Chain, Diamond Model, Zero Trust, STRIDE, PASTA, DREAD, ISO 27001

Web Dev Shopify, WordPress, Elementor, WooCommerce, Node.js, CI/CD basics

Platforms Kali Linux, Ubuntu, Windows Server, Windows 10/11, macOS, Cisco IOS, TryHackMe

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Pre-Security Certificate** — TryHackMe
- **Firewall Essentials** — Palo Alto Networks Academy
- **Cybersecurity Foundation Student Certificate** — Palo Alto Networks
- **Jr. Penetration Tester (PT1)** — TryHackMe (in progress)
- **Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH) v13** — EC-Council (in progress)

EDUCATION

BSc, Data and Cybersecurity | *University of Doha for Science and Technology* Jan 2022 – May 2026

- Part of a five-person research team under a PhD supervisor, working on LLM and agentic AI security.
- Grade A in Project Management; led all group projects across the programme and carried them to top marks.

High School Diploma | *Ideal Indian School, Doha, Qatar* Graduated Mar 2018

LEADERSHIP AND COMMUNICATION

- Group lead on every team-based university project; consistent top grades across group-based assessments.
- Comfortable writing technical reports and capstone-grade documentation in APA-7.
- Spent time on the ground at FIFA World Cup 2022 and at Qatar Airways — used to making calls under real pressure.
- Work in English; also fluent in Urdu, Hindi, and conversational Arabic.